

M02 NATURE AND PLACE | P

Intent : Support occupant well-being by incorporating the natural environment throughout the project and integrating design strategies that celebrate the project's unique identity.

Summary : This WELL feature requires the integration of nature throughout the project, as well as design strategies that celebrate the project's unique identity and inspires human delight.

Issue : Humans are increasingly living in environments where they have insufficient exposure to nature.^{1,2} Natural elements, such as plants and daylight, have been linked with health-promoting benefits, including decreased levels of depression and anxiety, increased attentional capacity, better recovery from job stress and illness, increased pain tolerance and increased psychological well-being.³⁻⁵ The incorporation of plants in the work environment is linked with improved employee morale, job satisfaction, and objective and subjective measures of productivity and with decreased absenteeism.^{4,6-8} Finally, the presence of water, natural light and nature views can impact mood, memory and performance in the workplace.⁹⁻¹¹ A dose-response relationship has been found with exposure to indoor nature, with studies showing that as workday nature contact increased, perceived job stress, subjective health complaints and sickness absence decreased.^{5,12,13}

Solutions : Incorporating natural elements into buildings can support occupant relief from stress and mental fatigue, as well as help establish a sense of place.¹⁴ The benefits of nature access can be achieved through numerous pathways such as direct (e.g., plants in the office), indirect (e.g., window views) or representational (e.g., photographs).⁴ Additionally, incorporating other key aesthetic elements, such as local culture, materials and art can help celebrate the project's unique identity and further enrich the space for occupants and visitors.

PART 1 PROVIDE CONNECTION TO NATURE

For All Spaces except Dwelling Units:

The project integrates the following throughout the space, including common circulation routes, shared seating areas and rooms (e.g., conference rooms, common spaces) and workstations (as applicable):

- a. Natural materials, patterns, shapes, images or sounds.^{9,15}
- b. At least one of the following:
 1. Plants (e.g., potted plants, plant walls).^{9,15}
 2. Water (e.g., fountain, pond, fish tank).^{9,15}
 3. Nature views.^{9,15}

PART 2 PROVIDE CONNECTION TO PLACE

For All Spaces except Dwelling Units:

The project integrates design elements that address the following:

- a. Celebration of culture (e.g., culture of occupants, workplace, surrounding community).¹⁶
- b. Celebration of place (e.g., local architecture, materials, flora, artists).¹⁶
- c. Integration of art.¹⁶
- d. Human delight.¹⁶

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